

Playing games in Linux

In the past, games have had been a mixed bag with Linux. The games landscape has come a long way in recent years, however it still needs perfecting. Large name companies are releasing their top titles for Linux as well as Windows these days, helping the overall popularity of Linux as a gaming platform no end.

Steam

Steam is a popular Windows (and laterally Macintosh) games platform. Steam hosts thousands of blockbuster titles, and is now available for Linux. Not all of the titles are available for Linux yet, but this seems to be a work in progress.

Native Linux Games

Many new games are being released 'natively' for Linux (that is, the software is written to work in Linux). Other games which will also work with Linux because they have been ported from their Windows base. Popular Linux games that you can play for free at the time of writing (January 2019) include Team Fortress 2, DOTA 2, War Thunder, Star Conflict, Robocraft, the zombie shooter No More Room in Hell and the new release of Super Tux Cart (yes, its Super Mario Cart, but with your favourite Linux mascot!). These are just some examples.

However, the number of natively available Linux games is still relatively low compared to Windows, there is a solution to offer some ability to play Windows only games – [Crossover](#) is a program which allows the user to play most of the Windows games titles within Linux. This software is not free, but is fairly priced (\$48 USD/yr), and offers a good degree of ease of use and includes support.

There are a great number of resources to find Linux games titles, both free and non-free. Check out the following for inspiration:

- [The Linux Game database](#)
- [Portable Linux Games](#) – Games that have been ported to Linux.
- Good old games: [gog.com](#)
- [Penguspy](#)
- [Gaming on Linux](#): Latest news about gaming in Linux